

- ▶ Vorbis - Vorbis audio streams are usually embedded in an Ogg or WebM container and support an arbitrary number of sound channels.

Audio and video restrictions

There are a few things that are not supported in the HTML5 audio and video specification:

HTML5 does not support audio and video streaming. That is, there is currently no standard for bitrate switching in HTML5 video; only full media files are supported by current implementations. However, there are aspects of the spec that are designed to support streaming media in the future once the formats are supported.

Media is restricted by HTTP cross-origin resource sharing.

Full-screen video is not scriptable because it could be considered a security violation to let a scriptable element take over the full screen. However, browsers have the option of letting users choose to view videos in full screen through additional controls.

Accessibility for audio and video elements is not fully specified yet. Work is underway on a specification called WebSRT for subtitle support based on the popular SRT format.

Browser support

As we can see there is no single combination of containers and codecs that works in all HTML5 browsers and it is not likely to change in the near future.

To make your video watchable across all of these devices and platforms, you're going to need to encode your video more than once –

1. Make one version that uses WebM (VP8 + Vorbis).
2. Make another version that uses H.264 baseline video and AAC “low complexity” audio in an MP4 container.
3. Make another version that uses Theora video and Vorbis audio in an Ogg container.
4. Link to all three video files from a single <video> element, and fall back to a Flash-based video player.

Using the HTML5 Audio and Video APIs

There are two main benefits to using these HTML5 media tags over previous video-embedding techniques—

With the new audio and video tags as a part of the native browser environment, it removes various deployment hurdles. Even though there are some